

period. Your success must not depend on news, overhearing tips, or market gossip. Economic data and quarterly earnings should not significantly impact your investments.

Last, you should be able to look back at your own behavior during volatile times without seeing anything embarrassing. Were you a buyer during the sell-offs of 2008–09, 2000–03, Q4 2018, the pandemic in 2020, and October 2022? Did you panic sell during those periods?

Answer these questions honestly to determine whether you have the temperament and discipline to manage your own money or not. If you have the time, interest, and discipline, there is no reason you cannot do it yourself. It is relatively easy: Select an asset allocation model, review it quarterly, rebalance once every few years, wait 30 years, and *voilà!* Retire happy.

If you need more assistance, find a good advisor. Look around. Ask friends and colleagues to recommend someone they have been happy with. Do your homework and talk with a few different advisors. Find somebody whose firm works with people in similar circumstances to yours. This is a very personal, intimate relationship, so make sure both you and your spouse like the person you will be working with.



One last thing: If you do hire a financial advisor, make sure they put your interests first.

The quality of advice varies widely. You already know the quality of *everything* you buy varies widely. You can buy a Chevy or a Mercedes. They may both be automobiles, but their design, build quality, horsepower, and reliability vary dramatically.

Regardless, wherever these cars are sold, the same basic safety regulations, crash-worthiness standards, minimum fuel economy, and consumer warranties apply to both. This is not true of financial advice. Two completely different standards govern advisors: *suitability* and *fiduciary*.